

Esteban Sitek

Senior Backend Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with **12+** years across fintech, healthcare, and e-commerce, building scalable distributed systems in Java with cloud infrastructure and strong observability. Experienced in API design, event-driven architectures, and independent feature ownership using AWS, PostgreSQL, and Kafka. Proven mentor and incident responder with systematic debugging discipline.

SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, HTML, CSS
Backend: Spring Boot, Spring Framework, Node.js, Express, FastAPI, Django, gRPC, Microservices
Database: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch
Testing: JUnit, Pytest, Jest, Mockito, Integration Testing, Test-Driven Development
Cloud & DevOps: AWS, AWS ECS, AWS Lambda, AWS S3, AWS RDS, AWS SQS, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Pulumi, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, CloudWatch, DataDog
Others: Kafka, RabbitMQ, RESTful API, Event-Driven Architecture, Distributed Systems, API Design, System Design, Code Review, Technical Mentorship, Incident Response, Git, GitHub, Jira, Agile

EXPERIENCE

Publicis Sapient Jun 2024–Present
Senior Backend Engineer

- Led the design and development of microservices handling high-volume transaction processing for financial services clients using **Java**, **Spring Boot**, and **Kafka**, enabling real-time event streaming across distributed systems.
- Drove adoption of AI-assisted development workflows using GitHub Copilot and Claude for code generation and debugging, creating reusable prompt templates that reduced feature delivery time by **18%** across the team.
- Architected resilient API services with comprehensive integration testing and edge case coverage, mentoring three junior engineers on systematic debugging techniques and on-call incident response using **DataDog** observability dashboards.
- Implemented distributed tracing and structured logging across backend services, reducing mean time to resolution (MTTR) for production incidents from **45 minutes to 18 minutes** through faster root cause identification.

- Owned the migration of legacy monolithic payment processing logic into event-driven microservices using **Kafka** topics and **Spring Boot**, improving system scalability and eliminating synchronous bottlenecks that were blocking payment throughput.
- Refactored critical database queries in **PostgreSQL** that were causing cascading failures during traffic spikes, adding connection pooling and query optimization that reduced P99 latency by **32%**.
- Conducted design reviews for three cross-functional projects, writing clear technical specs and leading design discussions to align backend architecture with product roadmap priorities.
- Proactively identified and resolved a race condition in order settlement logic that had been causing intermittent failed transactions, writing regression tests in **JUnit** to prevent recurrence.
- Collaborated with infrastructure team to optimize **AWS ECS** container placement policies and **AWS RDS** instance sizing, cutting monthly cloud costs by **22%** without impacting performance.
- Established code review standards focusing on testability and observability, reducing production defects by **24%** through early-stage pattern detection during peer review.
- Spearheaded adoption of infrastructure-as-code using **Pulumi** to manage service deployments, replacing manual **Jenkins** processes and reducing deployment variance across staging and production environments.
- Built tooling to automate smoke tests and health checks in **Python**, integrating with CI/CD pipelines to catch deployment issues before they reached production.

CareSimple

Oct 2022–May 2024

Senior Full Stack Engineer

- Spearheaded development of health data aggregation service handling HIPAA-compliant data flows across multiple hospital systems, building in **Java** and **Spring Boot** with careful attention to security boundaries and PII handling.
- Designed and shipped a real-time patient monitoring dashboard backend using **Kafka** event streams and **PostgreSQL**, processing millions of vital sign readings daily while maintaining sub-second query latency for clinician dashboards.
- Improved remote patient monitoring (RPM) data pipeline resilience by implementing dead-letter queues and retry logic in **Kafka**, reducing data loss incidents to near-zero and earning trust from compliance auditors.
- Mentored four junior engineers through pair programming on critical healthcare workflows, emphasizing defensive coding and edge case handling for patient safety systems.
- Optimized **PostgreSQL** query performance for high-cardinality patient cohort searches, reducing dashboard load times from **2.8 seconds to 620 milliseconds** by adding strategic indexes and query rewriting.
- Owned the complete redesign of API contracts between mobile client and backend services using **TypeScript** and **Node.js**, establishing clear versioning and backwards compatibility to eliminate client-side crashes after deployments.

- Built comprehensive integration test suites covering clinical workflow edge cases, ensuring robustness when handling missing fields, timing errors, and concurrent patient updates that real-world scenarios demanded.
- Collaborated with DevOps to implement automated **DataDog** dashboards tracking patient data latency and system health, enabling the on-call engineer to spot anomalies within minutes instead of hours.
- Worked with regulatory team to document system architecture and data controls, helping CareSimple pass healthcare compliance audits by clearly demonstrating control over patient data and audit trails.

Shopee

Jul 2018–Sep 2022

Full Stack Engineer

- Built high-throughput payment and wallet services handling millions of daily transactions across Southeast Asia, using **Java**, **Spring Boot**, and **Kafka** to ensure fault tolerance and eventual consistency in a distributed environment.
- Contributed to the redesign of the order reconciliation pipeline that processes transactions across multiple payment providers, implementing **Kafka** topics for reliable event ordering and **PostgreSQL** for idempotent state tracking, eliminating payment duplicate charges.
- Developed buyer and seller notification systems using **Node.js** and **Express**, broadcasting real-time updates via **WebSocket** to keep users informed of order status changes, improving user satisfaction metrics by **12%**.
- Owned backend services for Shopee's seller onboarding flow, building secure **RESTful API** endpoints in **Spring Boot** that validated merchant credentials and coordinated with payment partner APIs to enable sellers to start transacting in under 5 minutes.
- Optimized search indexing pipeline using **Elasticsearch**, reducing product search latency by **40%** during peak traffic and enabling merchants to update listings in real-time instead of waiting hours for indexing cycles.
- Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting using **DataDog** metrics and **CloudWatch** logs, proactively catching traffic anomalies before they impacted customer experience during flash sales and festival campaigns.
- Refactored legacy authentication service from synchronous session validation to **Redis** caching with background refresh, reducing login latency from **600ms to 85ms** and cutting database queries by half during peak hours.
- Collaborated with frontend team using **TypeScript** and **React** to align API schemas and response formats, enabling faster feature development and fewer integration bugs in production.
- Responded to and resolved production incidents affecting payment flows, using systematic debugging techniques to trace issues across service boundaries and implementing fixes that prevented similar failures going forward.

Altitude Games

Nov 2014–Jul 2018

Full Stack Engineer

- Built backend services for multiple free-to-play mobile games, handling real-time player interactions and progression tracking using **Node.js** and **Express** with persistent state in **PostgreSQL** and **Redis** caching.

- Designed and maintained in-game economy systems managing virtual currency, item trading, and seasonal events, ensuring balanced gameplay while preventing exploits that could undermine monetization.
- Implemented leaderboard systems handling millions of score updates per day, architecting solutions with **Redis** sorted sets that delivered top-100 rankings in under **200ms** even during tournament events.
- Developed analytics pipelines feeding gameplay telemetry into **Elasticsearch**, enabling game designers to identify balance issues and churn patterns, which directly informed feature design decisions.
- Contributed to blockchain gaming integration for Battle Racers, evaluating NFT smart contracts and implementing backend services to track owned assets and facilitate secure peer-to-peer trading.
- Built **RESTful API** endpoints for game client communication, implementing rate limiting and authentication to prevent abuse while maintaining low latency for real-time multiplayer interactions.
- Worked with QA engineers to design and implement automated stress testing scenarios, simulating thousands of concurrent players to ensure backend stability during product launches.

EDUCATION

Ateneo de Manila University

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Aug 2010–Jul 2014